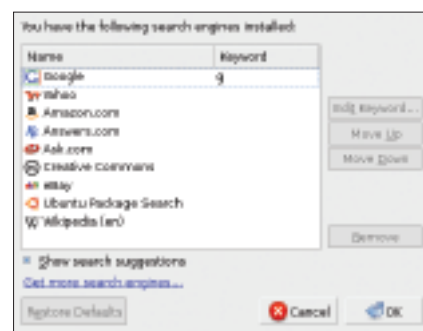


Opera-like Searching

When you type a search term in Firefox's address bar, you'll either get an error or be taken to the "I'm feeling lucky" Google result for that term. It's annoying that you'd have to change focus to the search box, when both Opera and IE support searching from the address bar itself—in Opera, you can precede the search term with "g" to use Google, "y" to use Yahoo, and so on. To get this in Firefox, first click on the arrow next to the search engine's icon in the search box and choose Manage Search Engines. Select a search engine and choose Edit Keyword. Enter a keyword of your



Add keywords for search engines

choice—"g" for Google, for example—and click OK. From now on, when you precede any search term with "g" in the address bar, Firefox will send you to the Google results for that term. Repeat for all other search engines.

Don't Zoom The Images

When you hold down [Ctrl] and scroll the mouse wheel to zoom into pages, you might not want images to resize and get distorted just so you can read text a little better. To enlarge only text, go to View > Zoom and choose Zoom Text Only.

Resistance Is Futile

It's no coincidence that Firefox 3's new mascot is a robot. You see, Firefox wasn't created by humans! Just type about:robots in the address bar to find a secret message from the creators. They claim they come in peace, but we know better...

EXCEL 2007

Adding Due Date Alerts

We all use Excel for keeping track of personal finance—paying bills, for

instance—wouldn't it be great if Excel could alert you of an approaching due date? Here's how you do it:

1. Select the cell that contains the due date and go to the Home tab.
2. Click the Conditional Formatting option in the Styles group and choose Manage Rules. This will invoke the Rules Manager dialog box.
3. Click on the New Rule button
4. Choose Format Only Cells that Contain
5. In the Edit the Rule Description area, make sure the first drop down list has Cell Value. The second drop down should be set to Less Than
6. In the formula area enter =Today() + 7
7. Click the Format button and in the colour drop down choose any colour you like.
8. Here, if the due date is within the next seven days, it changes to the colour you chose. You can create one more rule and replace the formula with Today() and changing the colour to say Red, so if the date is past due it will appear red.

Changing Gridline Colours

Firefox Keyboard Shortcuts

Command	Shortcut	Command	Shortcut
Navigation		Move Current Tab Left	[Ctrl] + Left Arrow
Back	[Alt] + Left Arrow [Backspace]	Move Current Tab Right	[Ctrl] + Up Arrow [Ctrl] + Right Arrow [Ctrl] + Down Arrow
Forward	[Alt] + Right Arrow [Shift] + [Backspace]	Move Current Tab to Beginning	[Ctrl] + [Home]
Home	[Alt] + [Home]	Move Current Tab to End	[Ctrl] + [End]
Open File	[Ctrl] + [O]	New Tab	[Ctrl] + [T]
Reload	[F5]	New Window	[Ctrl] + [N]
	[Ctrl] + [R]	Next Tab	[Ctrl] + [Tab]
Reload (override cache)	[Ctrl] + [F5]		[Ctrl] + [Page Down]
Stop	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [R] [Esc]	Open Address in New Tab (from Location or Search Bar)	[Alt] + [Enter]
Search		Previous Tab	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Tab] [Ctrl] + [Page Up]
Find	[Ctrl] + [F]	Undo Close Tab	Ctrl+Shift+T
Find Again	[F3]	Select Tab (1 to 8)	[Ctrl] + [1] to [8]
	[Ctrl] + [G]	Select Last Tab	[Ctrl] + [9]
Find As You Type Link	[']	Miscellaneous	
Find As You Type Text	[/]	Complete .com Address	[Ctrl] + [Enter]
Find Previous	[Shift] + [F3]	Complete .net Address	[Shift] + [Enter]
Web Search	[Ctrl] + [K] [Ctrl] + [E]	Complete .org Address	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Enter]
Windows And Tabs		Delete Autocomplete Entry	[Delete]
Close Tab	[Ctrl] + [W] [Ctrl] + [F4]	Full Screen	[F11]
Close Window	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [W] [Alt] + [F4]	Select Location Bar	[Alt] + [D] [Ctrl] + [L]
		Select Search Engines (when Search Bar is focused)	[Alt] + Up Arrow [Alt] + Down Arrow [F4]



HOW TO

Block Ads Now!

Closing the gate to sneaky ads no matter what the browser

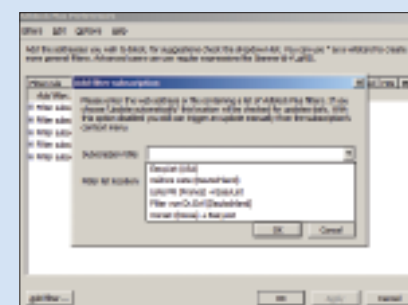
Advertisements are annoying to all of us. They do create revenue for sites, but most of the time, they are of little importance to the user and all they do is nibble away at your bandwidth. Sometimes, they can show inappropriate content as well. We are going to look at ways to disable or at least hide the ads off the screen with pretty much any of the most used browsers.

Ad Blocking In Firefox

Ads come in all forms and popups are one of the most annoying ways of which ads make their way on to the screen. Firefox, like most other browsers today, stops popups from appearing on the screen.

For blocking of advertisements, there is an extremely useful and well known add-on called Adblock Plus. Get it from <http://adblockplus.org/en/>. Click on the Installation link to go to that page to download the add-on. You have to click on the Allow button on the right top of the Firefox window to permit the add-on to be downloaded and installed. Restart Firefox.

Once Firefox starts, choose Tools > Add-ons. Click on Options for the



Adding subscriptions to Adblock Plus

Adblock Plus add-on. Click on Filter > Add filter subscription. Use the dropdown for Subscription title and choose the lists you want to add and click OK. Follow the steps to add additional subscriptions. Once added, click on Filters > Update all subscriptions. Click OK.

Ads should now be blocked by Firefox, and even if you do find some

ads that do make their way through the filters, right click on the image of the ad and click Adblock image...

Flash elements can also be disabled by using the Flashblock add-on for Firefox. This can be downloaded and installed from <http://flashblock.mozdev.org>. Flash elements will only work when you click on them.

Ad Blocking In Opera

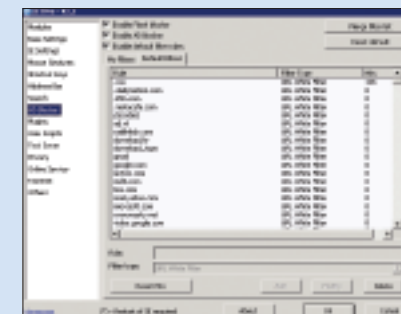
Opera has a built in popup blocker and an ad blocking feature as well. Using the ad blocker is as simple as downloading a text file and putting in the right folder. Opera's ad blocking works by referring to a file called url-filter.ini. There are many users who keep regularly maintained lists of ad hosts and domains.

One of the most famous one and most used ones is Fanboy's Adblock List (www.fanboy.co.nz/adblock/). Click on the Install now link or visit <http://fanboy.co.nz/adblock/opera/urlfilter.ini>. Save the file as it is to a folder and then move it to C:\Documents and Settings\Your_User_ID\Application Data\Opera_folder\profile. Linux users must copy to the .opera folder. When done, restart the browser and ad blocking will be enabled. Visit the site from time to time to update your ad block list.

Ad Blocking In Internet Explorer

Internet Explorer has been heavily criticized for letting popups and ads run loose but it too has a 3rd party add-on that users can download. It is called IE7Pro and can be downloaded from www.ie7pro.com. Click on the Download Free, download the installer and run it. In the last few steps of the installation you will be asked whether you want to enable spellchecking and if you want to set EasyHome as your homepage. Uncheck the boxes if you don't. Click Next and finish the installation.

Restart Internet Explorer and you will find an IE7Pro icon in the status



IE7Pro blocks ads and adds several other useful features missing in Internet Explorer

bar below or a button for IE7Pro Preferences in the toolbar above. Click it and then on AD Blocker. Enable Flash blocker to block flash items from web pages. You can also add your own filters in the My Filters tab. IE7Pro brings many more features than just ad blocking to Internet Explorer. Prefetching and mouse gestures are just some of these few features.

Universal Ad Blocking Across Windows

Ads can also be blocked across all browsers and applications running in Windows. This is done through a file called HOSTS that is located in C:\WINDOWS\system32\drivers\etc. Like the urlfilter.ini list that was used for Opera, similar lists are available for Windows. The list redirects domains to other domains or IPs. This way, none of the ads can be downloaded to your browser. Manual entries can be made by opening the file in a text editor. If you download a HOSTS file, copy it to the path mentioned above.

It is also a good idea to also have a spyware removal utility installed—they not only block ads, but malware and trojans as well. Spybot (www.safer-net-working.org) for example is one of such software. Keep it updated and run it from time to time and keep safe distance from possibly dodgy links and your PC should be just fine!

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